

D614

# Decision Process Engineering Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

A regional grocery chain with 85 stores wants to “cut produce spoilage by 15% within a year.” The chain’s CEO started out as a cashier. The analytics team must turn this into a technical requirement. Which statement is a technical requirement?

- A. Include the CEO’s cashier experience in the model.
- B. Use the most advanced AI available.
- C. Cut produce spoilage by 15% within a year.
- D. The system shall load each store’s sales and inventory data nightly and output next-day produce order quantities per store.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A technical requirement reads: “The system shall return a fraud score within 5 seconds of each card transaction.” Which business requirement most likely produced it?

- A. Give the board a monthly fraud-trend report.
- B. Return a fraud score within 5 seconds.
- C. Replace every card reader in the network.
- D. Reduce fraud losses by stopping suspicious purchases before they are approved.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3.

The finance vice president has final say over the project’s budget but shows little interest in its details. She is on vacation for the next two weeks. How should the project plan treat her?

- A. Keep satisfied: brief, targeted updates on budget-relevant items.
- B. Wait until she returns to begin stakeholder analysis.
- C. Manage closely with weekly detailed reviews.
- D. Monitor with minimal effort.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**4.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Warehouse clerks will use the new system every day and care a great deal about it, but they have no authority over funding or scope. Which strategy fits?

- A.** Keep satisfied.
- B.** Manage closely.
- C.** Keep informed.
- D.** Ignore them; no power means no role.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**5.**

A hospital improvement team, which meets every Tuesday in a newly renovated conference room, is drafting goals for its patient-discharge project. Which objective is written in SMART form?

- A.** Reduce average discharge time on medical floors from 5 hours to 3 hours by June 30.
- B.** Make discharges much faster.
- C.** Eliminate all discharge delays permanently.
- D.** Hold a discharge meeting every Tuesday in the renovated room.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**6.**

Midway through a project to build a sales forecasting model, a regional director asks the analyst to also add a customer-churn predictor “since the data is already there.” The director is well liked, and the extra work would take about three weeks. What is the best response?

- A.** Refuse all changes once the plan is signed.
- B.** Add it quietly since the data is already available.
- C.** Approve it because the director is well liked.
- D.** Log a change request, assess the impact on schedule and cost, and get sponsor approval before starting.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

7.

A project has four tasks. A takes 4 days and starts first. B (6 days) and C (3 days) both follow A. D (5 days) starts when both B and C are done. The team tracks the plan in a popular cloud scheduling tool. What is the shortest possible project duration?

- A. 18 days
- B. 6 days
- C. 15 days
- D. 12 days

|                             |                                           |                        |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>_____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In the same network (A 4, B 6, C 3, D 5; B and C follow A; D follows both), how many days can task C slip without delaying the project?

- A. 12 days
- B. 3 days
- C. 6 days
- D. 0 days

|                             |                                           |                        |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>_____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|

9.

A project risk register lists: data vendor delay — 30% chance, \$80,000 impact; key analyst leaves — 10% chance, \$150,000 impact; server outage — 50% chance, \$20,000 impact. The register was last updated by an intern in March. Which risk has the highest exposure?

- A. Key analyst leaves, because \$150,000 is the largest impact.
- B. Data vendor delay, at \$24,000.
- C. Server outage, because the most likely risk always matters most.
- D. Key analyst leaves, at \$150,000 exposure.

|                             |                                           |                        |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>_____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|

**10.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A risk has an exposure of \$18,000 and an impact of \$60,000. What probability was assigned to it?

- A.** 18%
- B.** 30%
- C.** \$42,000
- D.** About 333%

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**11.**

During user acceptance testing, a tester finds a heat map of store traffic that no one can trace to any approved requirement. It took two weeks to build and looks impressive in demos. What should happen?

- A.** Add a test case so it passes UAT.
- B.** Keep it because it demos well.
- C.** Flag it as out-of-scope work and have the sponsor decide, through change control, whether to keep it.
- D.** Delete every feature not in the original plan immediately.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**12.**

A county 311 service center resolves 62% of calls on first contact; the board's target is 80%. The center moved to a new phone system last spring and has 45 agents. What is the gap, and what is the next step in the needs assessment?

- A.** An 18-point gap; find the causes of the gap before choosing a solution.
- B.** An 18-point gap; buy a newer phone system.
- C.** An 18-point gap; hire more agents because 45 is too few.
- D.** The center exceeds its target by 18 points.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer D Concept 1

A regional grocery chain ~~with 85 stores~~ wants to “cut produce spoilage by 15% within a year.” ~~The chain’s CEO started out as a cashier.~~ The analytics team must turn this into a technical requirement. Which statement is a technical requirement?

**Target word:** identify a technical requirement **Decides:** A technical requirement says what the system must do.

|   |                    |                                                                           |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Camouflage         | Answers an irrelevant stem detail.                                        |
| B | Absolute language  | Vague and untestable; it names no required behavior.                      |
| C | Inverted operation | That is the business requirement restated, not its translation.           |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | States a system behavior that serves the business goal and can be tested. |

## 2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A technical requirement reads: “The system shall return a fraud score within 5 seconds of each card transaction.” Which business requirement most likely produced it?

**Target word:** business requirement — reversed from technical **Decides:** The 5-second limit only matters if purchases are stopped before approval.

|   |                    |                                                          |
|---|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Adjacent category  | A monthly report does not need a 5-second response.      |
| B | Inverted operation | Restates the technical requirement.                      |
| C | Confusion set      | A hardware project, not the need behind a scoring speed. |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | Real-time scoring serves a need to act before approval.  |

## 3. Answer A Concept 2

The finance vice president has final say over the project’s budget but shows little interest in its details. ~~She is on vacation for the next two weeks.~~ How should the project plan treat her?

**Target word:** stakeholder strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

|   |                   |                                                                                              |
|---|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | High-power, low-interest stakeholders get enough to stay supportive without detail overload. |
| B | Camouflage        | Her vacation does not decide her quadrant.                                                   |
| C | Adjacent category | That fits high power and high interest.                                                      |
| D | Dropped element   | Drops her power over the budget.                                                             |

## 4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

Warehouse clerks will use the new system every day and care a great deal about it, but they have no authority over funding or scope. Which strategy fits?

**Target word:** quadrant — low power, high interest **Decides:** Low power, high interest.

|   |                    |                                                                                     |
|---|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | Swaps power and interest.                                                           |
| B | Adjacent category  | Reserved for high power and high interest.                                          |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | Regular communication and a channel for input suit engaged users without authority. |
| D | Absolute language  | Daily users drive adoption and surface requirements.                                |

## 5. Answer A Concept 3

A hospital improvement team, ~~which meets every Tuesday in a newly renovated conference room,~~ is drafting goals for its patient-discharge project. Which objective is written in SMART form?

**Target word:** SMART objective **Decides:** Needs a measure, a baseline or target, and a deadline.

|   |                   |                                                  |
|---|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | Specific, measurable, time-bound, and plausible. |
| B | Dropped element   | No measure and no deadline.                      |
| C | Absolute language | Not achievable or time-bound.                    |
| D | Camouflage        | An activity, not an outcome objective.           |

## 6. Answer D Concept 4

Midway through a project to build a sales forecasting model, a regional director asks the analyst to also add a customer-churn predictor “since the data is already there.” ~~The director is well liked,~~ and the extra work would take about three weeks. What is the best response?

**Target word:** handling a scope request **Decides:** New work not in the approved scope.

|   |                   |                                                     |
|---|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| A | Absolute language | Valid changes can be approved through the process.  |
| B | Dropped element   | Skips change control; this is scope creep.          |
| C | Camouflage        | Popularity does not decide scope.                   |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Change control keeps scope, time, and cost aligned. |

## 7. Answer C Concept 5

A project has four tasks. A takes 4 days and starts first. B (6 days) and C (3 days) both follow A. D (5 days) starts when both B and C are done. ~~The team tracks the plan in a popular cloud scheduling tool.~~ What is the shortest possible project duration?

**Target word:** minimum duration **Decides:** Paths: A-B-D = 15 days; A-C-D = 12 days.

|   |                    |                                                         |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | Adds B and C in sequence although they run in parallel. |
| B | Wrong stem number  | The longest single task, not a path.                    |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | The longest path, A-B-D, is the critical path.          |
| D | Confusion set      | The shorter path; D cannot start until B is also done.  |

## 8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

In the same network (A 4, B 6, C 3, D 5; B and C follow A; D follows both), how many days can task C slip without delaying the project?

**Target word:** solve for float **Decides:** Critical path 15 minus C’s path 12.

|   |                   |                                                  |
|---|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| A | Wrong stem number | The length of C’s path, not its float.           |
| B | <b>Correct</b>    | $15 - 12 = 3$ days of float.                     |
| C | Confusion set     | B’s duration.                                    |
| D | Adjacent category | That is the float of tasks on the critical path. |

## 9. Answer B Concept 6

A project risk register lists: data vendor delay — 30% chance, \$80,000 impact; key analyst leaves — 10% chance, \$150,000 impact; server outage — 50% chance, \$20,000 impact. ~~The register was last updated by an intern in March.~~ Which risk has the highest exposure?

**Target word:** rank by exposure **Decides:** Exposures: \$24,000; \$15,000; \$10,000.

|          |                   |                                                         |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Dropped element   | Drops probability; $0.10 \times \$150,000 = \$15,000$ . |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | $0.30 \times \$80,000 = \$24,000$ , the highest.        |
| C        | Absolute language | $0.50 \times \$20,000 = \$10,000$ , the lowest.         |
| D        | Wrong stem number | Reports impact as exposure.                             |

## 10. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A risk has an exposure of \$18,000 and an impact of \$60,000. What probability was assigned to it?

**Target word:** solve for probability **Decides:** Probability = exposure / impact.

|          |                    |                                                   |
|----------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Wrong stem number  | Reads the exposure figure as a percent.           |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | $\$18,000 / \$60,000 = 0.30$ .                    |
| C        | Adjacent category  | Subtracts instead of dividing; not a probability. |
| D        | Inverted operation | $\$60,000 / \$18,000$ divides the wrong way.      |

## 11. Answer C Concept 7

During user acceptance testing, a tester finds a heat map of store traffic that no one can trace to any approved requirement. It took two weeks to build ~~and looks impressive in demos.~~ What should happen?

**Target word:** handling an untraced feature **Decides:** It traces to no requirement.

|          |                   |                                                                     |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | Testing proves it works, not that it is needed.                     |
| B        | Camouflage        | Demo appeal does not create a requirement.                          |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Traceability exposes gold plating; the sponsor decides its fate.    |
| D        | Absolute language | Approved changes may have been added properly; decide case by case. |

## 12. Answer A Concept 8

A county 311 service center resolves 62% of calls on first contact; the board's target is 80%. ~~The center moved to a new phone system last spring and has 45 agents.~~ What is the gap, and what is the next step in the needs assessment?

**Target word:** gap and next step **Decides:**  $80 - 62 = 18$  points; causes are unknown.

|          |                    |                                                    |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Gap analysis leads to root causes, then solutions. |
| B        | Dropped element    | Jumps to a solution without finding causes.        |
| C        | Camouflage         | Staff count was not shown to cause the gap.        |
| D        | Inverted operation | 62% is below 80%.                                  |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | Right                                                 | Wrong                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| Trap               | What it does                                                 | In this drill | Your misses |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 5             |             |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 4             |             |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 6             |             |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 6             |             |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 6             |             |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 3             |             |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 6             |             |

# Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                    | Rule                                                                                                                                                 | Trap                                                                | Tell                                                        |
|---|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Business vs. technical requirements</b> | A business requirement states the outcome the organization needs; a technical requirement states what the system must do to deliver it.              | Restating the business goal and calling it a technical requirement. | “Translate” or “which is a technical requirement.”          |
| 2 | <b>Stakeholder power/interest grid</b>     | High power + high interest: manage closely; high power + low interest: keep satisfied; low power + high interest: keep informed; low + low: monitor. | Ignoring low-power users or over-engaging busy executives.          | A stakeholder described by authority and level of interest. |
| 3 | <b>SMART objectives</b>                    | Objectives must be Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.                                                                       | Vague goals, absolute goals, or activities posing as objectives.    | “Which objective is written correctly?”                     |
| 4 | <b>Scope control</b>                       | New work goes through change control: log it, assess impact on scope, time, and cost, then get sponsor approval.                                     | Quietly absorbing “small” requests (scope creep).                   | A mid-project request that begins “since you’re already...” |
| 5 | <b>Critical path</b>                       | The longest path through dependent tasks sets the minimum project duration; tasks off it have float.                                                 | Adding all durations or picking the shortest path.                  | A task list with predecessors.                              |
| 6 | <b>Risk exposure</b>                       | Risk exposure = probability × impact; rank risks by exposure, not by impact or probability alone.                                                    | Ranking by the biggest dollar impact.                               | A risk register with percentages and dollar impacts.        |
| 7 | <b>Requirements traceability</b>           | Every deliverable should trace back to an approved requirement and every requirement forward to a test.                                              | Keeping untraced features because they look good (gold plating).    | A feature no one can link to a requirement.                 |
| 8 | <b>Needs assessment and gap analysis</b>   | Gap = desired state – current state; find the causes of the gap before choosing a solution.                                                          | Jumping from the gap straight to a favored fix.                     | A current metric, a target, and “what next?”                |

**Course scope (public description):** The Decision Process Engineering capstone integrates the learning in the MSDA core and the three courses within the specialization. The learner evaluates various needs and opportunities in an organization or marketplace; identifies the business requirements; translates the business requirements into technical requirements; and creates a comprehensive project plan to solve the problem in a way that satisfies the customer or business needs. Projects within this specialization include a project management plan, decision intelligence plan, or process engineering plan to deliver on the business need or opportunity.